

Quick Start Guide

5-Minute Railway Deployment

1 Get Your Database URL

From your hosting provider dashboard, copy your PostgreSQL connection string:

```
postgresql://username:password@hostname:5432/database_name
```

2 Get Gmail App Password

1. Go to [Google Account Security](https://myaccount.google.com/security) (<https://myaccount.google.com/security>)
2. Enable **2-Step Verification**
3. Go to [App Passwords](https://myaccount.google.com/apppasswords) (<https://myaccount.google.com/apppasswords>)
4. Generate password for “Mail” > “Other (Orlando Insider)”
5. Copy the 16-character code

3 Push to GitHub

```
cd ride-alert-monitor
git init
git add .
git commit -m "Initial commit"
git remote add origin https://github.com/YOUR-USERNAME/ride-alert-monitor.git
git push -u origin main
```

4 Deploy to Railway

1. Go to railway.app (<https://railway.app>)
2. Click **“New Project”** > **“Deploy from GitHub repo”**
3. Select your `ride-alert-monitor` repo
4. Railway auto-detects and deploys!

5 Add Environment Variables

In Railway dashboard > **Variables** tab:

```
DATABASE_URL=postgresql://username:password@hostname:5432/database_name
SMTP_HOST=smtp.gmail.com
SMTP_PORT=587
SMTP_USER=yourname@gmail.com
SMTP_PASS=abcdefghijklmnop # Your 16-char app password
SMTP_FROM="Orlando Insider" <yourname@gmail.com>
```

6 Verify It's Running

Go to **Logs** tab in Railway. You should see:

-  Orlando Insider - Ride Alert Monitoring Service
 -  Checking alerts every 2 minutes
 -  Testing SMTP connection...
 -  SMTP connection verified
-  Ride Alert Monitor - 2:30 PM (Orlando Time)
 -  Monitoring cycle complete

Done!

Your monitoring service is now:

-  Running 24/7
-  Checking every 2 minutes
-  Completely independent
-  Auto-restarting on errors

Troubleshooting

Can't connect to database?

- Check DATABASE_URL is correct
- Whitelist Railway's IP in your database firewall

SMTP errors?

- Verify you're using Gmail App Password (not regular password)
- Check SMTP_USER and SMTP_PASS are correct

Service keeps restarting?

- Check Railway logs for error messages
- Verify all environment variables are set

Need help? Check the full [README.md](#) (README.md) for detailed instructions.